

RAJESH DAMMALA

Forward Deployed Engineer

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[Rajesh Dammala - Forward Deployed Engineer](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer and reliability-focused technical leader with 16+ years of experience turning ambiguous operational and customer needs into production systems, automation frameworks, and measurable service outcomes. Built and operationalized AI-driven incident workflows, telemetry platforms, deployment processes, and cross-functional execution models across Azure and Xbox support ecosystems. Combines hands-on engineering depth with customer empathy, rapid discovery, and product judgment to shorten time-to-value, unblock complex implementations, and translate field constraints into scalable improvements.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| • Customer-Embedded Technical Delivery | • Discovery, Scoping, and Requirements Translation |
| • Production Rollout and Operationalization | • Workflow Automation and AI Enablement |
| • Integrations, Diagnostics, and Telemetry | • Customer Communication and Stakeholder Alignment |
| • Rapid Prototyping Under Ambiguity | • Field-to-Product Feedback Loops |
| • Escalation Handling and Outcome Ownership | • Full-Stack Operational Problem Solving |
| • Cross-Functional Delivery Across GTM, Product, and Engineering | • Time-to-Value and Adoption Acceleration |

SELECTED IMPACT

- Architected an AI-driven Azure SRE Agent platform that operationalized incident diagnostics and response workflows across production and non-production systems, enabling 30-35% automation potential across high-volume incident categories.
- Reduced operational noise by remediating 25,000+ stale or false incidents and streamlining 500+ alerts, improving support signal quality and shortening time-to-resolution for engineering teams.
- Authored 175+ troubleshooting guides and operational playbooks in 5 months to standardize response paths, accelerate onboarding, and reduce repeat escalation handling effort.
- Built telemetry and insight layers with KQL and Power BI to convert service data into executive-ready decision support, LiveSite trend analysis, and targeted remediation priorities.
- Led cross-functional execution across support, engineering, operations, and leadership stakeholders to redesign escalation workflows and improve operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Delivered AI copilots and automation initiatives with an estimated 122K USD annualized savings while improving diagnostic throughput and reducing manual triage backlog.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager / SRE Program Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra / Allyis) | May 2021 - Present

- Operate as a customer-proxy and engineering bridge for high-severity support and operational issues, translating ambiguous incidents and stakeholder needs into concrete diagnostics, routing, and remediation workflows.
- Designed and deployed Azure SRE Agent workflows integrating ICM, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Kusto, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, and Teams notifications to enable production-grade incident automation and faster triage.
- Built reusable operational patterns, playbooks, and onboarding automation that reduced engineering toil, improved time-to-value for internal teams, and scaled reliability practices beyond one-off interventions.
- Used telemetry analysis to identify recurring operational pain points, quantify failure patterns, and shape remediation priorities with engineering and service owners.
- Balanced immediate unblock-and-deliver work with scalable product judgment by distinguishing one-off operational exceptions from repeatable platform opportunities.
- Drove stakeholder clarity during critical incidents through concise technical communication, executive-ready narratives, and clear decisions around scope, risk, and next action.

Azure Support Technical Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Nov 2016 - May 2021

- Worked directly with enterprise Azure customers and internal stakeholders on subscription, migration, identity, and capacity issues requiring both technical diagnosis and business-sensitive communication.
- Led a team of 15 engineers supporting complex customer-facing cloud issues, shortening resolution paths through structured escalation and better service coordination.
- Escalated customer pain into product and engineering channels, helping close gaps between supported workflows and real-world operational requirements.

Operations Lead - Azure LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | May 2012 - Nov 2016

- Built strong discovery instincts through deep investigation of Azure production failures, mapping technical dependencies and operational constraints rapidly across distributed systems.
- Automated high-friction operational processes with PowerShell, reducing repetitive effort and enabling engineers to focus on higher-value problem solving.
- Led globally distributed operations teams in complex, high-stakes environments where clear communication, prioritization, and calm execution were required.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering - JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional: Implementing Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- TechMahindra AI White Belt
- Google Introduction to Generative AI
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- TechM Curated AI for Beginners

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Role Keywords: Forward Deployed Engineer, customer-facing engineering, technical delivery, production deployment, system design, integration engineering, workflow automation, AI workflows, agentic systems, LLM deployment, observability, incident automation, customer discovery, requirements analysis, technical scoping, stakeholder management, time-to-value, adoption, field feedback, product feedback loop

Cloud and Platform: Microsoft Azure, Azure App Service, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure Data Factory, Azure DevOps, Azure Key Vault, Azure Active Directory

Observability and Operations: Kusto Query Language, Power BI, LiveSite Operations, Incident Command, Root Cause Analysis, MTTR Reduction, Alert Rationalization, SLA/SLO/SLI

Automation and AI: PowerShell, Bicep, Infrastructure as Code, Logic Apps, CI/CD Pipelines, Generative AI, AI copilots, Agentic workflows, Multi-agent orchestration, Azure SRE Agent

Leadership: Executive communication, Customer and stakeholder management, Cross-functional program delivery, Escalation leadership, Technical mentoring, Global team leadership